Love Is Dangerous

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/91266331.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Castaspella/Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Characters:
Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra), Norwyn (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Emotionally Repressed, Internalized Homophobia, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Feelings Realization, emotional struggle, Light Spinner never got corrupted, Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, partner prompt event, SPOP Creative Flex (She-Ra)

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Love Is Dangerous

by xAsleepxForeverx, Xenakis (IceRosesCrown)

Summary

Light Spinner, renown tutor in Mystacor, realizes the truth about herself after finding an old picture...

Notes

Welcome everyone!! I hope you enjoy this fic written and illustrated for the Partner Prompt Event in the Spop Flex Server hosted by Astryn and Rea!!! Many thanks for organizing it!!

The title of this fic was hard to finally decide, but this song turned out to be a great fit!!
~Xenakis

Yup, the title was kinda hard to decide. I gave an idea for a title which was "Afraid Of These Feelings." and then Xenakis here gave other ideas off of my idea then we decided to go with a song title! Anyway, Enjoy this little fic!
-xAsleepxForeverx

See the end of the work for more notes

It was a cozy evening in Castaspella's house.

In the bedroom, Light Spinner was laying on their bed against the pillows as she waited for Castaspella to finish up her shower.

She thought of getting up to grab a book. However, the bathroom door opened just as Light Spinner sat up.

Castaspella stepped out, her body wrapped snug in a towel while she used a second towel to dry her hair.

Light Spinner cracked a smirk as she glanced at the other sorceress.

"Done now?" Light Spinner hummed. "I must admit you look a little more relaxed."

Castaspella gave a slight chuckle in response.

"I feel more relaxed, yes." The sorceress responded. "Today's meeting and the work I had to do afterwards was just a lot."

Castaspella moved over to the wardrobe and grabbed a pair of pajamas, while Light Spinner layed back against the pillows once more before speaking again.

"Well, maybe you can relax and perhaps get some sleep now."

Castaspella shook her head, but not without a grin, as she stepped behind a changing screen.

"It sure is a shame you can't be there anymore."

Light Spinner scoffed at that.

"Yes. But… I got kicked out for 'a good reason' according to you."

"Well, of course!" Castaspella shot back. "Attempting the Spell of Obtainment with a student after Norwyn told you not to is a very good reason."

"I suppose I should count myself lucky that they stopped me." Light Spinner huffed, but then sighed. "I could have caused serious harm to that student or others. And if I had been successful? I likely would have died."

*Lately, after getting together with Castaspella, Light Spinner had begun to **slowly** realize how much harm and damage she could have caused if the spell had succeeded.*

Castaspella sensed the shift in the atmosphere after stepping back out from the changing screen, and got an idea to change the subject.

"Say… You still good at Poker?" Castaspella asked, grabbing a deck of cards.

Immediately, Light Spinner smirked playfully.

"*Am I still good*?" Light Spinner crossed her arms over her chest. "I bet I could still beat you."

After a couple of games and one glass of wine each, Light Spinner layed awake reading a book while Castaspella slept in her arms.

For about ten minutes, Light Spinner read quietly.

But soon, she set the book aside and glanced down at Castaspella, tightening her arms slightly around the younger woman.

The longer she looked at her, the more Light Spinner started to think back to how this all started. To how their relationship came to be…

Light Spinner was sitting in front of Norwyn's desk, about to finish her monthly review.

She wasn't a fan of her actions and herself being under scrutiny at the end of every month, but since her "little mistake", she had no choice if she wished to remain in Mystacor.

However, she didn't really know *why* she refused to leave.

Was it pride? Did she feel like leaving her home in the Island would be accepting defeat?

Maybe a part of her wished to be forgiven?

She would *not* ask for forgiveness anyways, but…

Whatever it was, she had already been through this for almost a year. What would be the point of ditching everything now?

—Alright— Norwyn sighed. —Everything seems in order. I'm glad you've been behaving.

—Sure you are— she scoffed, making her veil flutter slightly. Folding her arms she rolled her eyes with annoyance. —Admit it, you don't want me back at the Council at all, do you? None of you do…

—You know that doesn't matter. You cannot return after what you did— he reminded her. —But, if you want to know, there *is* someone who probably wishes you to be back.

—Oh, really?— she let out, raising a brow, curious. —And who would that be?

—Must you ask? Who else but Castaspella?

—Don't be ridiculous— the woman replied, clicking her tongue. With a mocking smirk under her veil, she added —No one should be more glad than her that I'm gone. Maybe more than you…

—Really? Why so? I thought you both were…

—What? *Friends*?— she interrupted. —I have no friends…

—I mean it, Light Spinner— he insisted. —In fact, I thought you two were *partners*— he laughed.

—You're definitely being ridiculous, Norwyn. Stop spouting nonsense.

—I suppose I was wrong, then. But that's the impression I had— he sighed. —In any case, you're free to go now.

Standing up, Norwyn tidied up his paperwork, then saw Light Spinner out.

As she walked away, his words echoed in her mind.

What a stupid idea.

Ridiculous!

How utterly…

…*insane*.

Light Spinner hadn't even thought about Castaspella in a while. Or… at least had tried not to.

After being removed from the Council, that sorceress wanted to keep in touch as much as possible. And she had allowed it at first. She wouldn't say it aloud, but she did consider her a friend… somehow.

But then…

Then she… was… *weird*.

Light Spinner felt- She didn't know what she was feeling, just that she suddenly felt the urge to get *away* from Castaspella.

Hence, she simply did. She turned down her offers to hang out, didn't receive her any time she visited, and eventually, the sorceress ceased all contact on her own.

She had never allowed herself to dwell on it, and now that she did, she felt that odd thing again.

It seemed to be a mix of fear and disgust.

But for what?

Now she really didn't want to think about it anymore.

Light Spinner soon arrived at her room, pushing away her thoughts, and immediately went to take a bath to relax a bit.

Once out, she grabbed a cup of wine, and decided she wanted to read, however, she wished to read one specific book.

And she couldn't find it.

Digging around among her things, she found a box stashed at the back of her closet, and sure enough, remembered that was where she put many of her books.

Once she pulled it out, she went through it to get what she was looking for, yet came across many old things she thought she had thrown away.

Trinkets and memories of her old friendship with Castaspella. Birthday presents, random gifts… and a frame with a picture of them having breakfast.

She was… surprised to see herself *not* wearing the veil.

Light Spinner guessed they must have been somewhere alone, but… she couldn't believe she had really- Was she that close with the sorceress?

Was that the reason Norwyn had that impression of them being…

Impossible.

Not a chance.

Never would she…

No!

A cracking sound pulled the woman out of the spiral her mind was falling into, and she looked down to see that her left hand was pressing down so hard on the frame that her thumb had cracked the glass.



Her heart shrunk for a second, she didn’t know why, and before she knew it, she had let the picture fall.

Stupid fragile thing…

As soon as it hit the ground, the frame broke beyond repair, and sudden rage took over her.

Why did she suddenly felt her eyes sting?

She wasn't about to cry, was she?

How much of a fool could she be!?

No, absolutely not.

She wouldn't cry. She didn't care. She should have thrown that away long ago, anyways.

She should have…

And why was she feeling like this!?

Her hands shook and she had to sit back on her bed before *she* fell to the ground.

Was she missing Castaspella?

Could it- No!

She didn't want to, ever, see her again!

She couldn't…

She wouldn't!

However, this pressure on her chest; what did it mean?

She despised the sorceress, didn't she!?

So why would she care about this broken frame!?

Unless…

That had to be it.

Castaspella had *charmed her*, hadn't she!?

She must have!

Well, then. She'd have to see her *one last time*, to fix this and return to her solitude.

It was already late when Light Spinner arrived at Castaspella's place and "knocked" on the door with her closed fist.

She felt quite envious, in fact, that the sorceress had her own house on the Island instead of a mere room like she and the other acolytes.

Perks of being a long-lasting member of the Council…

Part of her regretted being there.

What was she doing!?

Well, she knew, but…

No, no. She had to do this.

She wouldn't leave until the sorceress undid that stupid charm.

Banging on the door a second time, Light Spinner called out — Open the door, Castaspella. I know you're there.

She waited for a moment before attempting to bang again, yet before she could, the door finally opened.

—Beatrix?— the sorceress uttered, shocked.

—Don't call me that— Light Spinner immediately spat. —We must talk.

—I- Su-sure. Come in— Castaspella accepted, moving aside. — Have you come to apologize?— she then scoffed, closing the door.

—That would be a first.

—Apologize!?— she exclaimed, laughing sardonically. —You wish.

Castaspella's whole demeanor immediately changed.

She shook her head in disbelief, folding her arms, and looked away for a second, indignant.

—After so long, after pushing me away, why did you suddenly reach out if not to apologize!?— she finally managed to ask, glaring at Light Spinner.

—I want to you undo whatever you did to me!

What!?

—What did I ever do to you!?— the sorceress asked, completely at a loss.

—Don't deny it. You did *something*, and I want it *gone*— Light Spinner accused her, stepping closer.

Castaspella's shock only increased as she tried to figure out what that meant.

—I have no idea what you're talking about! I have done *nothing* to you other than love you!— she admitted, her expression pained.

—I don't believe it— the woman denied, shaking her head.

Of course she wouldn't.

—That doesn't change the truth!— Castaspella insisted. —I've loved you for a long time, despite your-your *spitefulness*!— she went on, with a mix of pain and anger. —But you!? You pushed me aside! You started to ignore me! Why!? Because I showed interest in you!?— she asked, laughing nervously.

Did she *not* know!?

From her expression, it would seem so.

Light Spinner looked at her in disbelief as she began —You can't be serious. You-you're…

—I am *what*!?— Castaspella interrupted, almost guessing it.

—A *freak*!?

A resounding slap across the face surprised Light Spinner.

—Don't you *ever* call me that again— the sorceress said with a low tone, more serious than she had ever been before. As tears streamed down Castaspella's cheeks, the old woman could do nothing more that stare in shock. —I want you to leave now. If you think that of me, if you hate me so much, then *be gone*.

For a moment, Light Spinner had no idea what she had done.

But then she shook her head, ordered her thoughts and insisted —Not until you undo it.

—Undo *what*!?— Castaspella asked again, reaching the limit of her patience.

—What you did to me! I'm feeling- You *must* have done *something*!— Light Spinner struggled to explain.

And that made it all clear for the sorceress.

Of course.

—Oh. *Oh*! Is that *it*!?— she laughed, once she got over her surprise. —You- Damn… I never thought you'd be- But *of course* you'd be a repressed fool!— she let out, disgruntled. —And with how stubborn you are, there's no way you'll ever accept yourself, is there!?— she realized.

—There's *nothing* to accept— Light Spinner denied.

With that, Castaspella rolled her eyes, understanding there was no point in trying to convince her.

—Then *leave*! I have no time to waste with hateful scared fools— she angrily said, pointing at the door.

—I am not…

—Yes, you are!— she interrupted. —You're a coward! You realized you have feelings for me, but you're *so scared* of what those feelings might be, that it might be *love* for another woman, that you don't even let yourself explore it!— Castaspella insisted. —So, I'll say it again, *leave*. And *don't* come back. Do what you do best and *ignore me*— she cried. Folding her arms, she turned around to conclude —I did nothing to you. You'll have to deal with it *alone*. After all, I am a *freak*, am I not?

The mocking tone at the end hid a hint of pain that Light Spinner easily caught; maybe because of that, she didn't say anything else and, reluctantly, left the place.

Light Spinner arrived to her room well into the night.

She felt strange.

Her mind was a mess, and her body seemed specially heavy.

It was as if she had been ran over by a horse-pulled cart or something…

To be fair, she had been emotionally ran over, but she couldn't accept that.

She couldn't…

After a few tries, she managed to properly cast the unlocking spell and entered her room. Right after closing, she let herself fall on her bed and stared at the ceiling for a long time.

Sighing…

After losing count of how many deep sighs she had let out, she decided to prepare herself some tea; with any luck, it would lull her to sleep.

While it brewed, she changed into her night robes, moved the bedsheets side, and finally grabbed that cursed book she had been looking for.

Once she had her tea, Light Spinner got into bed, began reading, and little by little drank her tea.

A few hours passed, she finished her tea, also the book before noticing, and yet no traces of sleep.

Still, she decided to turn off the lights and attempt to rest, closed her eyes and covered herself.

However, the silence and darkness finally allowed those chaotic thoughts of her to return.

The book had kept her distracted, but now…

Now Castaspella's words had returned to her.

She had called her a *coward*.

Why!?

What did she mean!?

She couldn't really be implying that she had some sort of… repressed feelings, right?

No, that was exactly what she meant. She said it clearly.

She told Light Spinner she was scared to explore those feelings…

But she- No. She didn’t- She *couldn’t* be feeling anything for real!?

It *had* to be a spell messing with her!

Or… was it?

In any case, she simply couldn’t sleep like this.

She couldn’t stop going over her “conversation” with Castaspella, if it could even be called that, and she refused to think about this now.

So sleep be damned, she’d do something else.

Anything else.

Research probably would distract her, yes…

-Present-

The next morning, Castaspella was the first to wake up. She glanced at Light Spinner, and smiled warmly seeing that she was still asleep.

Quietly, she moved herself out of the older sorceress's arms and rose from the bed.

After brushing her hair, she remained in her pajamas for the time being and headed to the kitchen to prepare some breakfast for them and then a coffee for the older sorceress.

The younger sorceress stepped into the kitchen and got out what she needed for the breakfast.

She prepared the ingredients before starting on the coffee.

Minutes later, she had a coffee made for Light Spinner when she'd wake up, and then some moon-berry tea for herself.

She set both cups down after taking a sip from hers and turned to the stove to get started on cooking breakfast.

Light Spinner finally woke up a while after Castaspella left the room.

After taking a good stretch, the older sorceress kicked the blankets off of her and rose from the bed.

She straightened her hair out from the slight mess it was in from her sleep and headed out of the room and to the kitchen.

As soon as Light Spinner stepped inside, the welcoming smell of breakfast and coffee hit her, and she cracked a grateful smile as Castaspella turned in time to see her.

"Hey Bea. Slept well?" The younger sorceress asked as she handed the older sorceress her coffee.

"I could say I did, I suppose." Her partner answered as she took a sip of her coffee.

Castaspella smiled and set two plates of breakfast on the table before sitting down.

It was french toast drizzled with syrup and topped with moon-berries. Their favorite dish.

"Thanks for always making breakfast, Es." The older sorceress muttered as she sat down and took a bite of the food.

"You're welcome." The younger sorceress smiled after taking a couple bites of her own. "I wouldn't let you try cooking again. Last time you had quite the mishap and burnt almost all of it."

"Well… At least I tried?"

"Yeah. You tried at least. But I should probably teach you more on how to cook before I let you touch the stove again." The younger sorceress laughed.

At that, Light Spinner shook her head with a fond grin before taking another bite.

Castaspella seemed to like teasing her about certain things.

And although it kind of annoyed her once in a while, when it came to Castaspella, she knew she wouldn't have things any other way.

This was her life now, and she enjoyed it.

But then? She started to think about the past again.

It had been hard for her, but finally facing her fears and being honest was the best decision she could make.

Light Spinner felt like a small boat in the middle of a storm.

Her feelings were all over the place, and she refused to acknowledge them.

Sleep was impossible to achieve, save for when exhaustion finally claimed her, but that meant she spent a few days without getting any rest before she eventually passed out one night.

That way, it would now be a week since her “conversation” with Castaspella, and all the sorceress could think about were her words.

She was in the middle of helping an acolyte with their investigation, but her mind was elsewhere.

Was she really a coward? Was she trying to suppress something?

Well, she was certainly scared of those damned feelings that had been haunting her. Why else would she keep avoiding them?

But maybe, if she gave it a moment…

…could she understand what it was all about?

What was she feeling? And why did she refuse so stubbornly to find out?

—Excuse me, Light Spinner— the acolyte called. —Are you alright?

—Of course. Why do you ask?— she replied, with her best neutral expression.

—You've been spacing out for a moment and didn't answer my question.

—Apologies— she sighed. —Could you repeat the question?

—I wanted to know how to measure the strength of this defense spell. It's supposed to be a shield, but all shields have an specific strength, and this one isn't described in this book— they explained.

—Ah, a defense spell…— Light Spinner let out, inevitably thinking about Castaspella since this one, in fact, is her area of expertise. —The strength of a defense spell is measured according to how it's drawn and the strength of the caster. Magical shields *amplify* the natural strength of the caster, but how much they amplify it depends on how well the sigil was drawn. Is that clear?

—Yes. I- Then, should I test the shield for my research?

—I suggest you seek out… Castaspella… to help you with it, lest you end up hurting yourself— Light Spinner suggested, making the acolyte giggle. —What's so funny?

—It's the third time you've mentioned her— they began. —And it's curious that you don't offer *your* help, despite priding yourself in being the most talented tutor— they then added, giggling again.

—What is that supposed to mean?— she asked, raising a brow.

—Nothing! Nothing…

—I demand you tell me right now!— Light Spinner insisted, frowning.

—I-it's nothing! I promise! It's… I don't know, nice to hear you, uh, acknowledge someone's skill instead of…

—Instead of?— the sorceress asked, raising a brow again. —Were you going to say "undervalue them"?

—I-I mean…— the acolyte faltered, looking down. —I mean no disrespect, Light Spinner. It-it was an observation.

—It may amuse you, but those observations of yours are uncalled for, and I do *not* appreciate them— she replied. —So what if I mention a fellow tutor? I am no monster. If I believe someone else can help you better than me, why wouldn't I point you their way!?— she indignantly said. —Is that what everyone thinks? That I would disregard someone else's skills, just to make myself look better than them!?

—Light Spinner…

—Answer me!— she demanded.

—Yes, it is— the acolyte firmly replied. —I apologize if it upsets you, but that *is* what everyone thinks!— they confirmed, folding their arms. —I'm among the few who admires you as a tutor, so I *really* mean no offense. But…

—But?

—You sometimes behave in a way that… makes me wonder if you're actually a good person…

—I'm- Do I really…— Light Spinner began asking, yet trailed off.

—Besides, since you were kicked from the Council, you've been mean when talking about the current councillors. For acolytes like

me, that made us hesitate— they admitted, looking away. —That's why today, hearing you mention Castaspella so many times and in a good tone, I just thought…

—What did you think?

—That your grudge against the Council was finally gone— they concluded. —That maybe you're… a good person, after all, and were just having a bad time because you were kicked out…

—I see— Light Spinner sighed. —Have I really mentioned Castaspella so much?

—Three times in the past hour, every time I mentioned defense spells— the acolyte smirked. —But that's good. It just means you appreciate her, and recognize her skills.

She… appreciates Castaspella?

No, no. She-she despises the woman! For *betraying* her!

Betraying…?

How exactly did she… betray her?

—Why are you telling me this?— the sorceress asked, expression darkened as she tried to keep her thoughts in check.

—Well, Castaspella is also my tutor, and the last week she's been under the impression that…

—That what!?

—That you hate her— the acolyte replied, slightly scared. —We've been telling her that's not true, but…

—Why would she care about what I think of her?— Light Spinner scoffed. —I am but a blight in the Council's history. No one cares about my opinion in the slightest.

—That's not true— they denied. —But I… guess I've been speaking out of turn. My apologies.

—You have— she nodded. —Do you have further questions about this?

—No, Light Spinner.

—Then I shall leave you to it— she decided, before walking away.

As Light Spinner walked back to her room, not wanting to deal with anyone else that day, she couldn't help reflecting on the conversation.

Had she been thinking about Castaspella that much?

Why!?

And she wasn't exactly thinking about her with resentment… just… *thinking*.

As the acolyte said, she had even shown good regard of Castaspella's skills.

Was it so strange?

Apparently, from her, it was…

At the same time, Light Spinner felt so strange now, considering all of this.

As she finally arrived to her room, the sorceress decided to take a bath, wanting to clear her mind.

However, as she stepped under the shower, all those feelings she had been ignoring suddenly returned to invade her calm mind.

She didn't want to, but her conversation with the acolyte made her curious enough to finally give those damned feelings a

chance.

To… explore them, as Castaspella had said.

And once again, those words resounded in her head.

She *was* thinking about the sorceress, she was…

Missing her, maybe.

Was that it? What she felt, was it some kind of longing?

Light Spinner found herself reminiscing about those breakfasts shared, the gifts exchanged, the projects they had worked on together…

And that picture.

She now remembered that day, and it had been… a happy moment.

Then she thought about Castaspella's proximity.

Not only did she take off her veil around the sorceress, she had also shared so much about herself, about her family; things she wouldn't have told anyone.

So why tell *her*? Did she really feel that comfortable around Castaspella?

Was that what made her suddenly feel the need to retreat?

Was she… falling in love?

She could now remember exactly when her behaviour changed.

It was some time after being kicked from the council. Now she realized… that it was because, once, during the whole day, Castaspella had been showing her affection… more than usual; Light Spinner became hyper-aware of their occasionally joined hands, of the proximity, of how the sorceress would lean on her

every time she could… And then that night, as she read a book for Castaspella the same way they usually did, the sorceress once again leant on her, fell asleep even.

That was when Light Spinner began feeling strange, and maybe it wasn't that she disliked it, but rather that *liked it* and that scared her.

She didn't want to feel that again, so she began pushing Castaspella away.

Now the sorceress had told Light Spinner she loved her… Asked if she had been pushed away for showing interest.

And she was right.

So, could she fix what she had done?

Maybe… just maybe, there was a chance.

And even if there wasn't, Light Spinner now felt the urge to tell Castaspella what she realized. She wasn't fully comfortable with it, but she couldn't keep denying it and she *wanted* the sorceress to know.

Cutting her shower short, she quickly rinsed herself, got dressed again, and despite it being late already, she rushed to Castaspella's home.

Light Spinner knocked on her door several times, almost desperately, begging her to open.

She even said "please".

—I don't want to talk to you— Castaspella answered, without opening the door.

—I need to tell you something! I… it'll be a moment. If you don't want to see me again after this, I won't bother you anymore. Please, Es…— she insisted.

Taken aback by the way she said it, especially the nickname, the young sorceress finally gave in and opened.

—You have five minutes— she severely said.

—That's enough— Light Spinner nodded. —I… wanted to tell you that you were right… about me. I-I was scared, trying to ignore it, but I've been feeling something I didn't understand nor wanted to admit. Something… I thought I disliked for some reason, but the more I thought about it, the less sense it made, so I realized I was… scared, actually— she explained. —So now, this cowardly fool has come here… just to tell you that… I love you— she admitted, her heart hammering on her chest as she stared at a shocked Castaspella.

—You- I- You came back… despite me telling you not to— she pointed out, still a bit shocked. —Why?

With a bitter laugh, Light Spinner replied —I simply ignored you. It's what I do best.

With tears in her eyes, Castaspella let out a choked laugh as she nodded, reaching out to cup the old woman's face.

—Thank you, Bea— she muttered.

—I did nothing other than upset you.

—You did, but you also faced that fear you had… and… I couldn't be happier— she admitted. Sniffing, she then asked —Will you stay now?

—I won't push you away again— Light Spinner replied, placing her hand over Castaspella's against her cheek. —I swear… I'll be here. For you.

End Notes

Alright, that was it!! Thank you for reading!! :D
I hope you liked it and that you liked the art ^_^
~Xenakis

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!